



Quick Guide to Mealworm Farming

Mealworm Life Cycle

- Eggs hatch in 4–12 days.
- Larvae (mealworms) eat, grow, and molt for weeks/months.
- Pupae rest and transform (1–2 weeks).
- Adults (darkling beetles) breed and lay eggs → cycle continues .

Step-by-Step Setup

1. Prepare trays: Fill with dry substrate (4–6 cm).
2. Add larvae: Place mealworms (2–4/cm²) on top.
3. Moisture source: Add slices of carrot/potato/apple.
4. Placement: Keep trays stacked in a warm, dark, slightly humid area..

Maintenance

Frass removal: Sieve out droppings regularly → use as fertilizer.

Check environment:

- Temp: 25–28 °C
- Humidity: 50–60%

Smell: Fresh/grainy (bad smell = too wet or uneaten food).

Pest check: Remove mites, moths, or other intruders .

Feeding

Dry feed: Bran, oats (base substrate).

Wet feed: Fruit/vegetable scraps 2–3 times/week.

Tip: Only give what they eat in 1–2 days → prevents mold & pests .

What You Need

Trays/Crates: Shallow, stackable, ventilated boxes.

Feedstock: Wheat bran, oats, bread crumbs, or crop by-products (3–5 cm layer).

Moisture Source: Carrot, apple, or potato slices (avoid citrus/moldy food).

Starter Mealworms: 500–1000 larvae from pet shops or online.

Tools: Sieves (to separate life stages), scoops, thermometer-hygrometer, spray bottle.

Conditions: 25–28 °C, ~60% humidity .

Harvesting & Breeding

Harvest larvae: When ~10% pupate (5–10 weeks). Sieve them out.

Fasting: Keep larvae 24h without food before use.

Storage: Freeze, refrigerate (dormant), or dry.

Breeding:

Transfer pupae → beetles.

Place beetles in new tray with substrate & mesh (prevents egg cannibalism).

After 2–4 weeks, move beetles again — old tray becomes “egg tray” → new larvae .



- Be patient — cycles take weeks.
- Don't overwater.
- Keep trays clean.
- Rotate trays for continuous production.





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Useful Links

Mealworms

Starter mealworms: <https://myreptileshop.gr/product/alevroskoulika-mealworms-1kg/>

or

Contact:

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info@fraudline.gr :Fraud Line/ INNOFY (coordinator of the project)

entofarmproject@gmail.com : Project's official email address

What You Need

Trays/Crates: <https://www.leroymerlin.gr/gr/apothikeusi-taktopoiisi/plastika-koutia-kai-kalathia/koutia-apothikeusis/kouti-plastiko-43-l-61798506>

Sieves: <https://www.skroutz.gr/s/33257050/Koskino-apo-Anoxeidoto-Atsali-151087.html#specs>

Scoops: [https://www.skroutz.gr/s/29440526/Viosarp-Sesoula-Plastiko-VIO8697404114598-4tmch.html?](https://www.skroutz.gr/s/29440526/Viosarp-Sesoula-Plastiko-VIO8697404114598-4tmch.html?product_id=61699195&sponsored=listing)
[product_id=61699195&sponsored=listing](https://www.skroutz.gr/s/29440526/Viosarp-Sesoula-Plastiko-VIO8697404114598-4tmch.html?product_id=61699195&sponsored=listing)

Thermometer-hygrometer: <https://www.skroutz.gr/s/25233726/Xiaomi-Mi-Monitor-2-PSifiako-THermometro-Ygrasiometro-gia-CHrisi-se-Esoteriko-CHoro-NUN4126GL.html>

Spray bottle: <https://www.skroutz.gr/s/55587378/Keskor-Docheio-Ladiou-Sprei-Gyalino-220ml-42649-2-Mayro.html>

Brushes: <https://www.skroutz.gr/s/42931900/TnS-Pinelo-Vafis-Isio-3tmch-31-950-0062.html>

Heating lamp: <https://www.reptiliumshop.gr/el/reptizoo-energy-saving-heat-lamp-with-infrared-radion-80w.html>

Heating pad: <https://www.reptiliumshop.gr/en/repti-zoo-heat-mat-10-watt-20-x-20-cm.html>

Desk fan: <https://www.skroutz.gr/s/23229577/Primo-PRMF-80421-Anemistiraki-USB-Epanafortizomeno-1200mAh-Leyko.html>



Start your farm with everyday items you already have at home, learn how the insects respond to changes, and slowly improve your setup as you go.



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<https://www.ento.farm/>

